# Far-Right Speeches and Emotional Contagion in Parliament

Sequential and Multimodal Evidence from Germany

Christian Arnold
University of Birmingham

**Andreas Kuepfer**
TU Darmstadt

Christian Stecker
TU Darmstadt

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- Instead: **more positive** emotional language
- Interpretation: rhetorical distancing from a norm-breaking actor

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**But this is an average, entry-level, text-based result**

- Aggregates across speeches and time
- Cannot reveal *immediate* reactions within debates
- Cannot capture *how* responses are delivered

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## The Multimodal Dimension

Speech is not only text: legislators communicate through pitch, head movement, and gestures.

- Do responses become vocally and visually activated?
- Are these channels coupled, or do they move independently?
- **Expected**: text follows text, pitch follows pitch, visuals follow visuals

# Research Design and Case Selection

## Research design

ONE AGENDA ITEM

| Speech | Speech | Speech | **Far Right** | Speech | Speech | Speech |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|

← **Before** **After** →

**Before**
non far-right sentences

**vs.**

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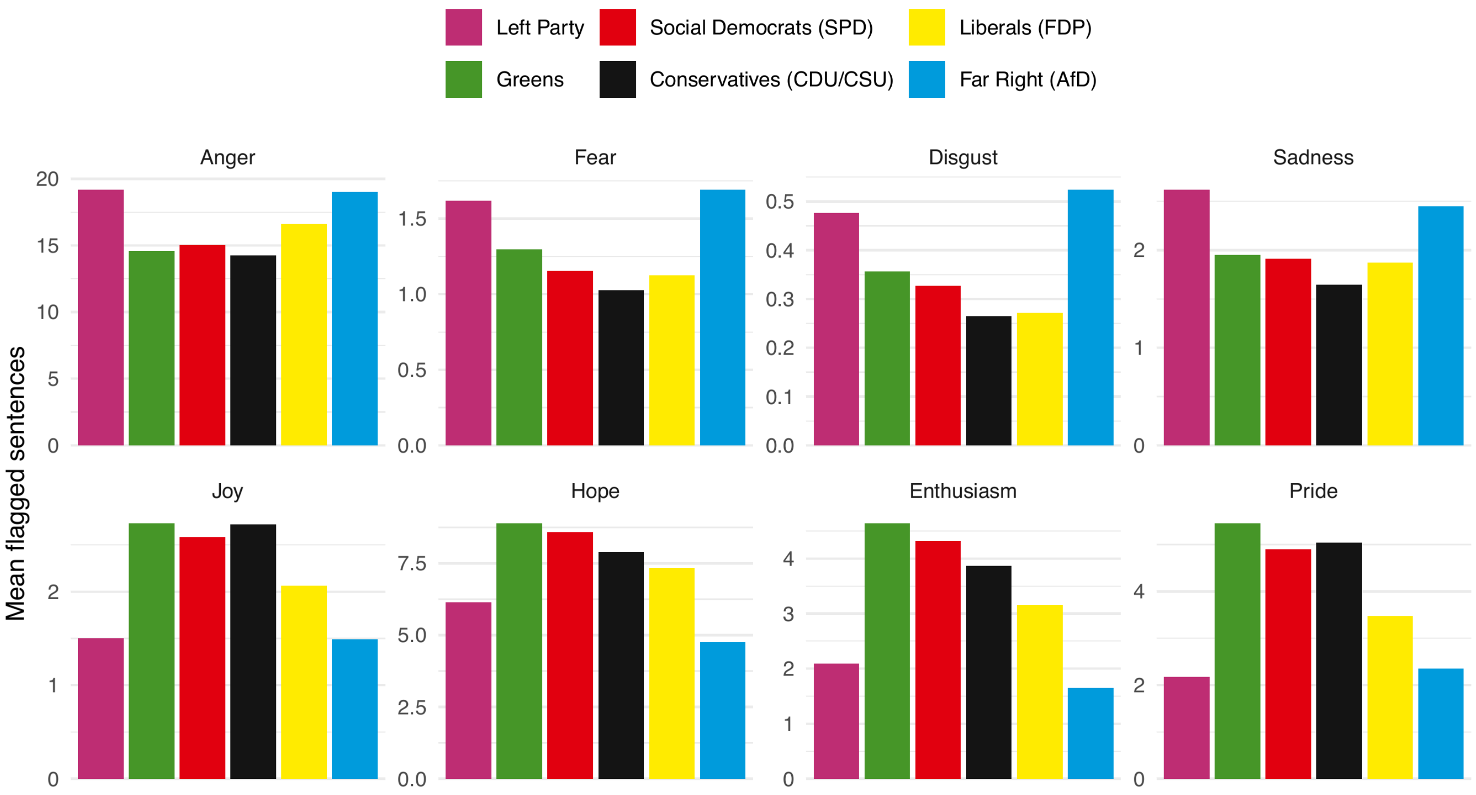
## Case Selection

49,662 speeches in ~15,000 hours of video:

| Parliament | Period | AfD from |
|---|---|---|
| Hesse | 2013–2025 | 2019 |
| Saxony-Anhalt | 2021–2025 | 2021 |
| Saxony | 2019–2025 | 2019 |
| Baden-Württemberg | 2011–2025 | 2016 |
| Bundestag | 2017–2025 | 2017 |

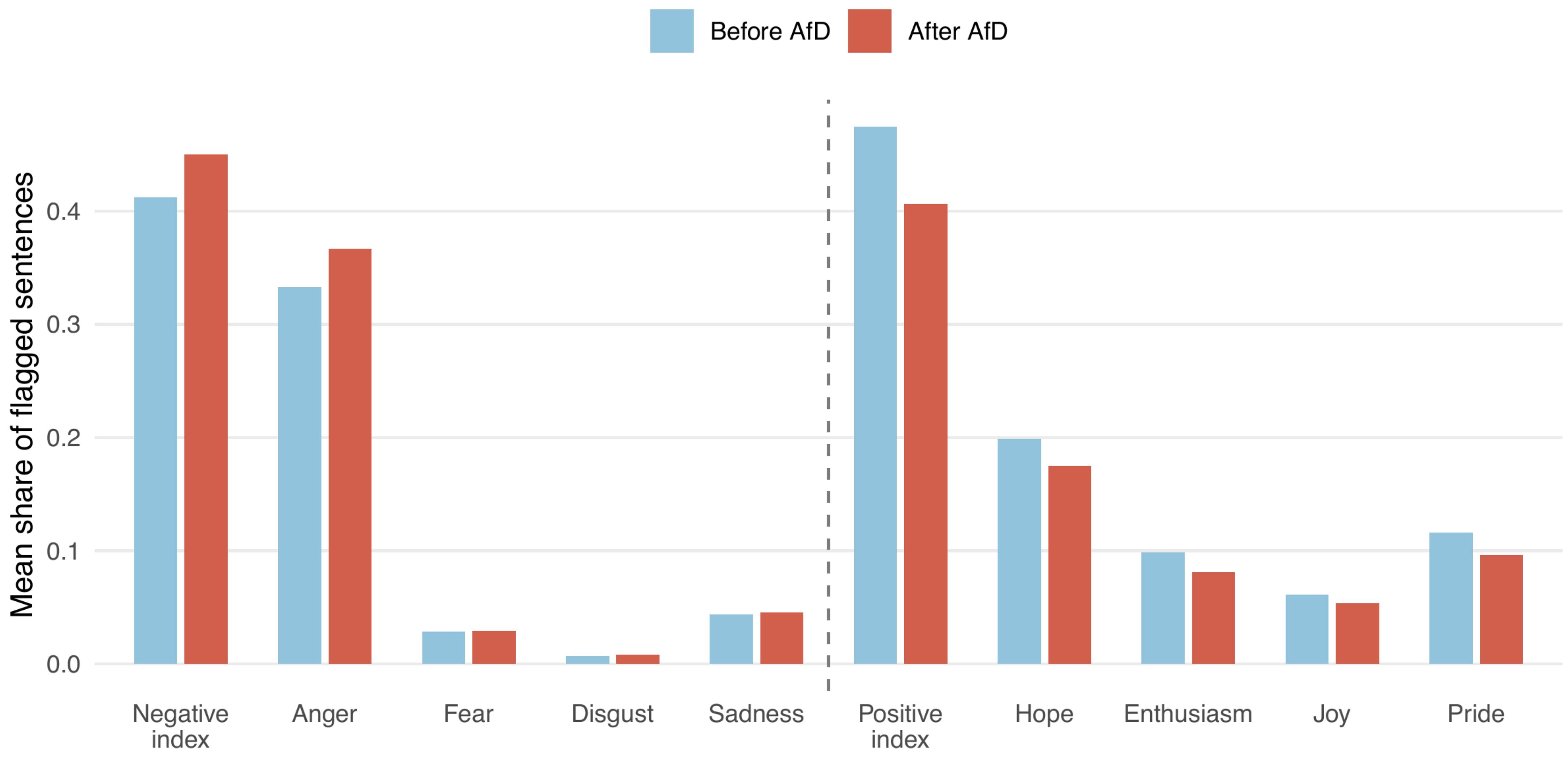
# Average Distancing

**H1:** Non-AfD parties respond to AfD presence with more positive language (replication)



# Average vs. Sequential Mirroring

**H2:** Speeches *after* AfD interventions contain more anger and less positive language (descriptive)



# Average vs. Sequential Mirroring

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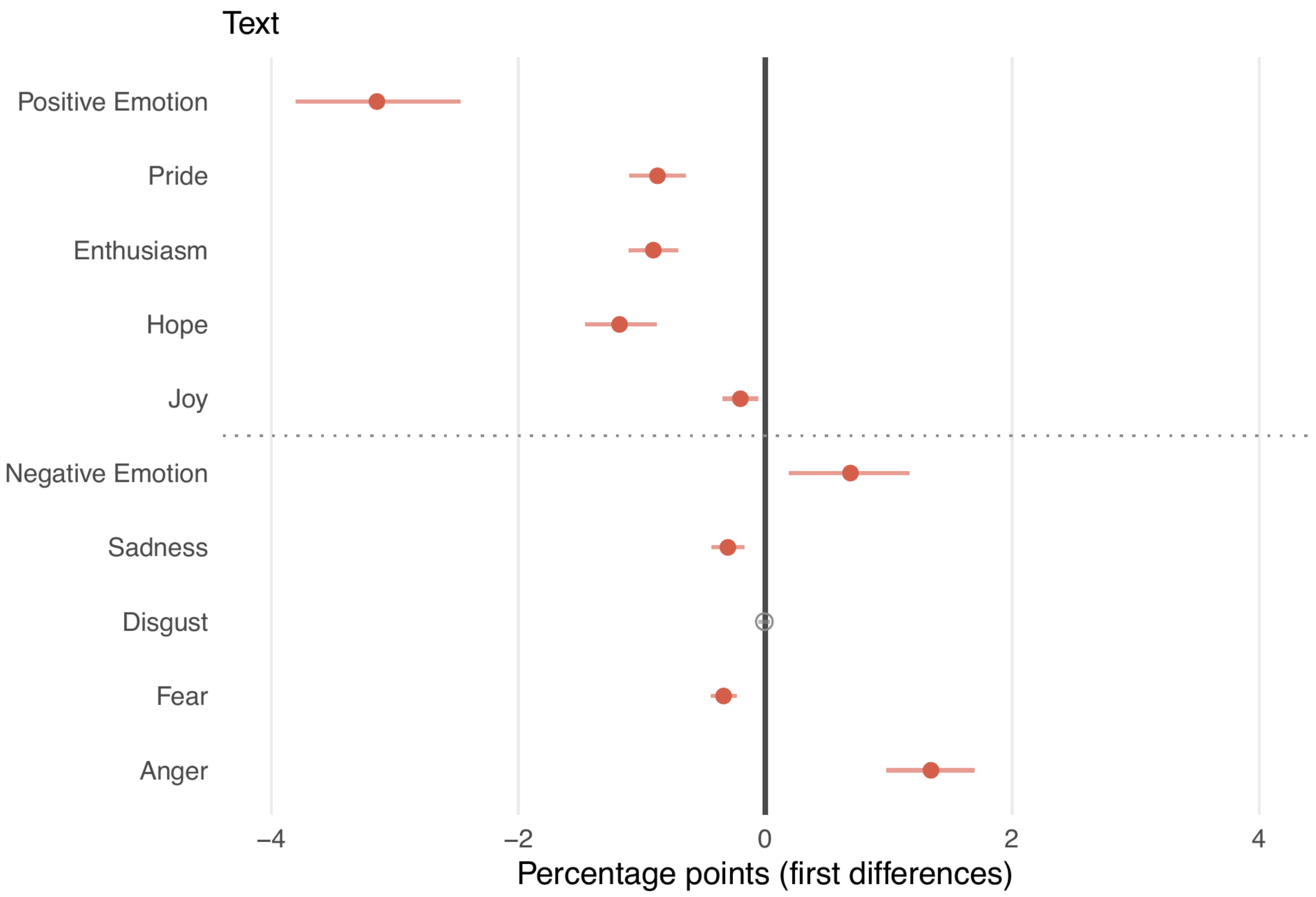

# Modality- and Emotion-Specific Transmission

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**H4a/b: Emotion-specific coupling**

- Far-right anger → pitch elevation (H4a)
- Negative → negative; positive → positive (H4b)

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**Causal identification:** DiD using the pre-AfD-entry period as control; shifts in the post-AfD window vs. baseline behaviour

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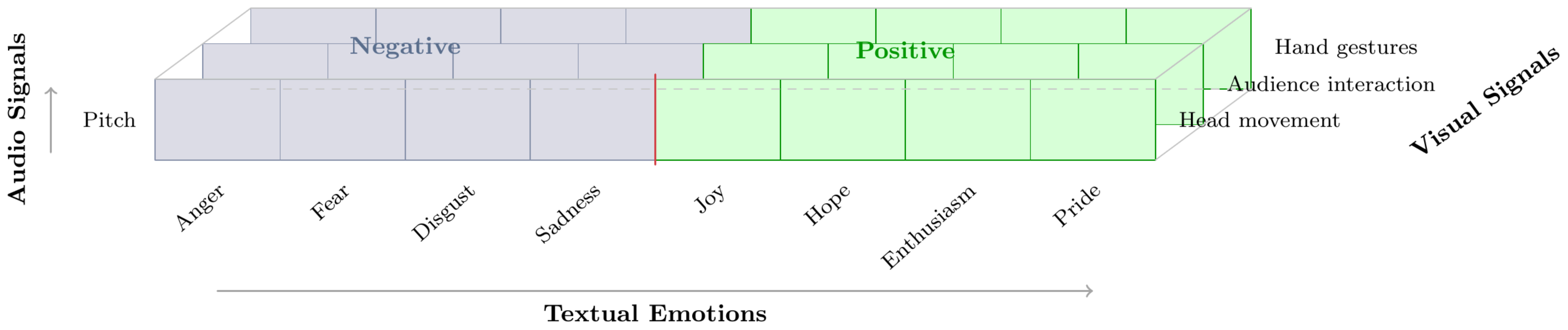
**Contact:**
andreaskuepfer.github.io
andreas.kuepfer@tu-darmstadt.de
ankuepfer@bsky.social

# Measurement Framework

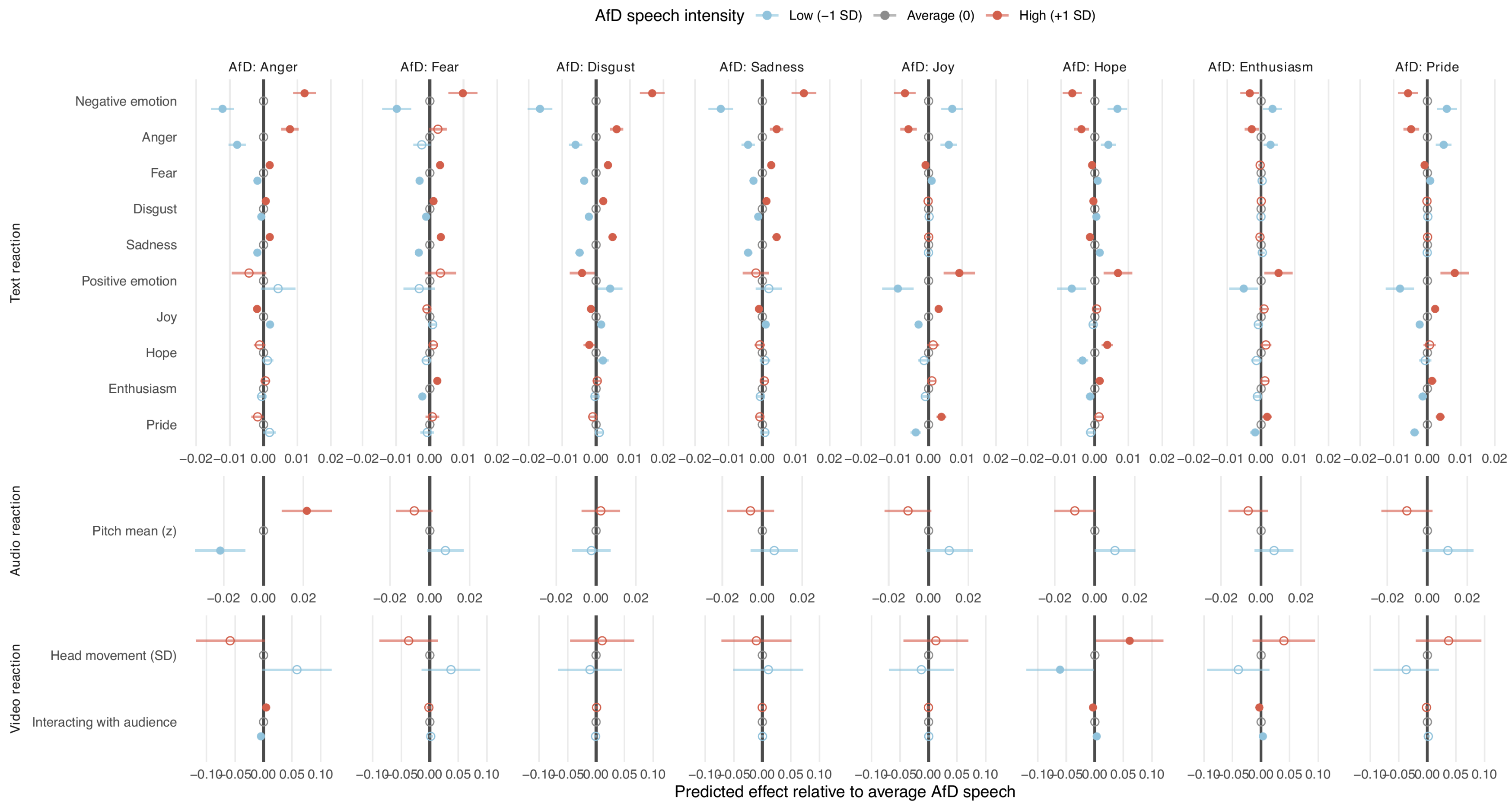
Three dimensions:

- **Text** (8 discrete emotions: anger, fear, disgust, sadness; joy, hope, enthusiasm, pride)
- **Audio** (vocal pitch)
- **Visual** (head movement, audience interaction, hand gestures)



# Emotion-Specific Coupling

**H4a** Increased far right anger → pitch elevation; **H4b** Negative (positive) emotions transmit Negative (positive) responses



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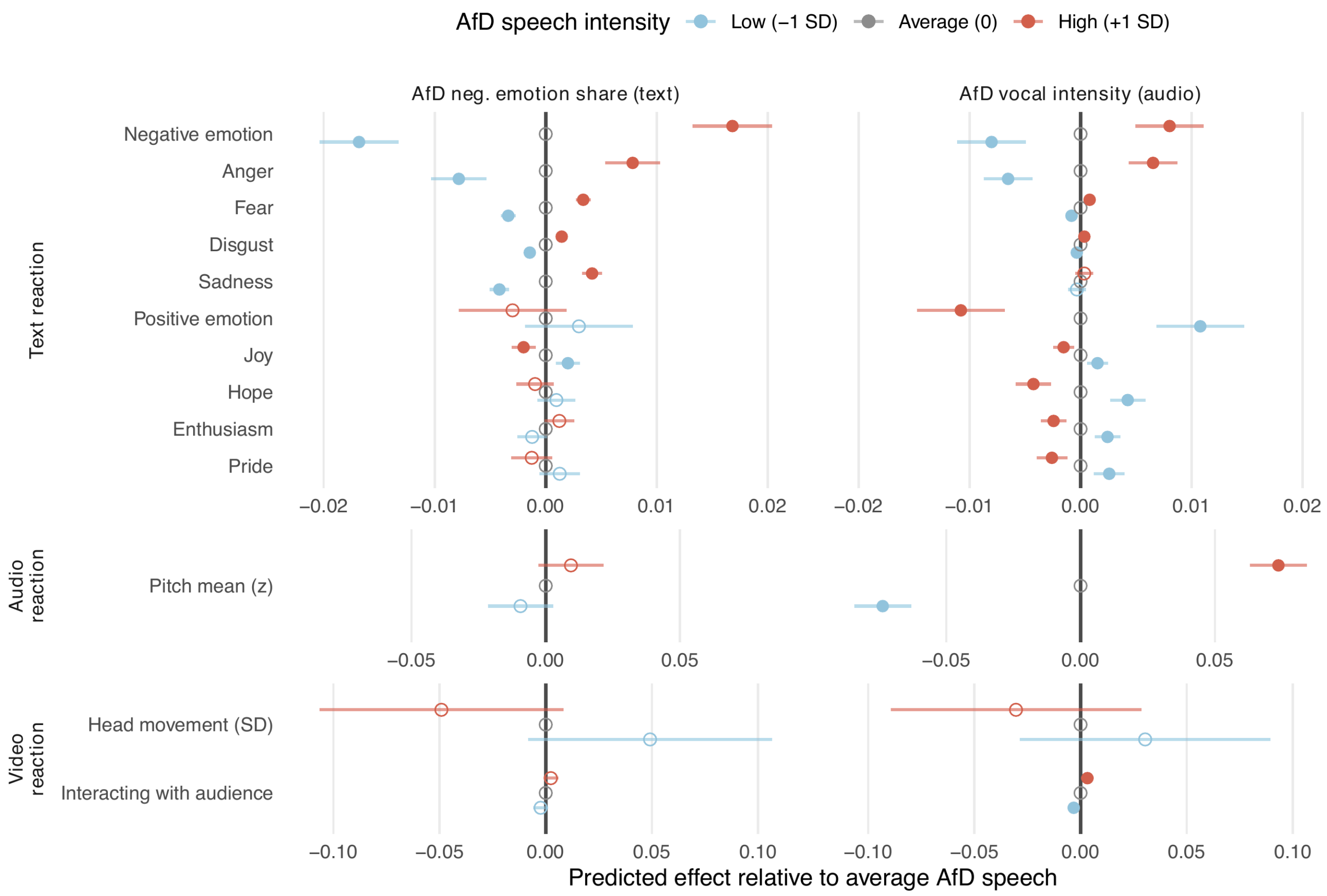

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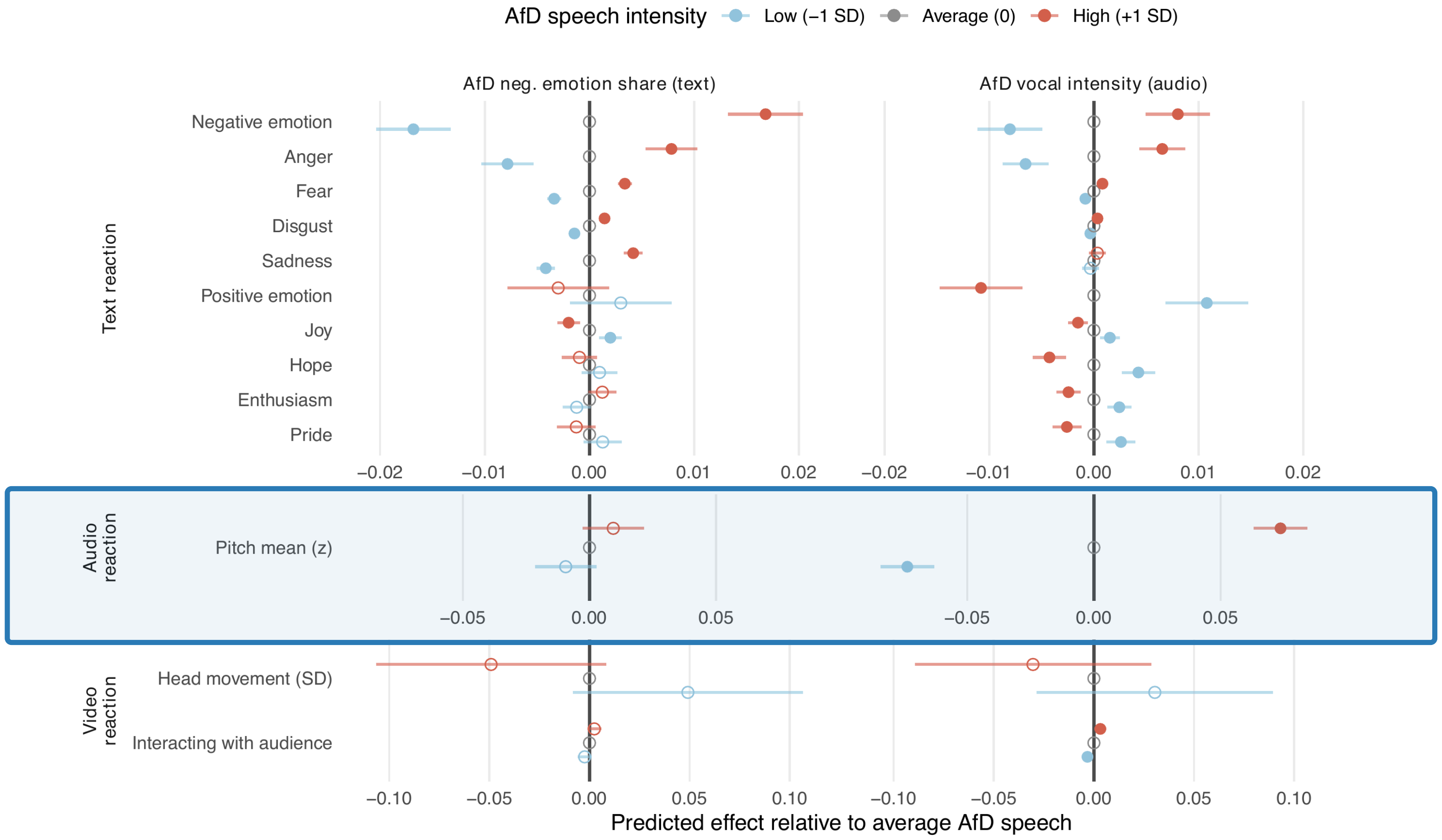

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